

Revised User Personas & Journey Maps for Smart-Save

1. Persona: "Techie Idris" (The Young Professional)

Photo:	(Image of a man in his late 20s, wearing casual smart clothes, looking at his phone on a coffee break)
Demographics:	Age: 28 Occupation: Software Developer Location: Lagos, Nigeria Income: ₦450,000/month (gross)
Bio:	Tobi is digitally native and earns a good salary. However, lifestyle inflation, social pressure, and numerous automatic subscriptions (Netflix, Spotify, etc.) mean his money vanishes each month. He feels guilty and stressed about his inability to save, despite his income. He's tried budgeting apps but abandons them because they require too much manual work and make him feel restricted.
Goals:	● Build a 6-month emergency fund (₦1.5M). ● Save ₦300,000 for a vacation to Zanzibar within 12 months. ● Feel financially confident without it feeling like a chore. ● Get a clear, automated view of his spending without stress.
Frustrations:	● He feels ashamed about not saving, despite his high-tech salary. He is mentally exhausted after work and doesn't have time for other things. ● Manual tracking is a frustrating reminder of his failure to keep up. ● He makes spending decisions in the moment (e.g., buying rounds for friends) and regrets them later when he sees his empty account.
Motivations:	● Primary: Automation (to remove guilt and effort), ● Positive Reinforcement (to feel good about progress), ● Simplicity. ● Data & Insights Quote: "I know I should be saving; I just want an app that handles it for me. I don't want to think about it."

User Journey Map: Techie Idris

Scenario: Idris gets a notification that his rent auto-debit cleared, leaving his account low. He feels that familiar panic and searches for a solution.

Stage	Actions	Thoughts & Feelings	Pain Points	SmartSave Opportunities & Solutions
Awareness	Sees a sponsored post from a tech influencer he trusts.	"Another 'financial freedom' ad. But this one says 'set and forget'... that sounds different." (Feeling: Skeptical but Intrigued)	Feels targeted by irrelevant ads; doesn't trust generic finance promises.	Trusted Validation: Partner with credible Nigerian tech influencers who can authentically demo the app's automation.
Onboarding	Downloads app. The first screen asks, "What's one thing you'd love to save for?" He selects "A Vacation."	"Okay, it's not just asking for my bank details immediately. It's starting with my dream." (Feeling: Hopeful)	Worried about complexity and security from the get-go.	Goal-First Onboarding: Start by capturing user aspirations before any setup, making the process feel rewarding and purposeful.
Setup & Value	Links his primary bank account. In under 2 minutes, his transactions sync and are automatically categorized.	"Whoa. It already knows I spend a fortune on 'Food & Drinks'. It's not judging me, just showing me." (Feeling: Surprised, Relieved)	Fear of being judged for spending habits; past apps categorized things wrong.	Instant Gratification: Ensure the first data sync and categorization are fast and accurate to provide immediate value and build trust.
Regular Use	Gets a gentle push notification: "You saved ₦2,500 this week from round-ups! You're 10% to your Zanzibar goal."	"I saved money without even noticing? Okay, this is the magic I needed." (Feeling: Accomplished, Motivated)	Needs positive feedback, not just alerts about overspending.	Celebrate Micro-Wins: Use notifications primarily for positive reinforcement (savings milestones, round-up totals) to build a habit and feel-good factor.
Loyalty	He hits his 3-month emergency fund milestone. The app generates a shareable	"I'm actually doing it! Maybe my followers struggling with the same	Wants recognition for his achievement and to help his peers.	Social Proof Engine: Create easy, non-sensitive ways for users to share

	graphic. He shares it on Twitter.	thing should try this." (Feeling: Proud, Empowered)		successes, turning them into brand advocates.
--	-----------------------------------	---	--	---

2. Persona: "Freelancer Faith" (The Gig Worker)

Photo:	(Image of a woman in her early 30s working from a cafe with a laptop and notebook)
Demographics:	Age: 31 Occupation: Graphic Designer & Freelancer Location: Abuja, Nigeria Income: Irregular, ranges from ₦200k - ₦800k/month
Bio:	Faith's income is unpredictable, making traditional budgeting with fixed categories feel impossible. She needs to separate business and personal expenses, smooth her cash flow, and save for taxes. This unpredictability makes her anxious. She constantly worries about covering bills and taxes, which leads to either feast-or-famine spending. She feels traditional budgeting is pointless because her income is not regular.
Goals:	• Create financial stability despite irregular income. • Automatically set aside 15% of every payment for taxes. • Save ₦30k/month on average for a new laptop.
Frustrations:	• The constant anxiety of "when will the next payment come?" is mentally exhausting. • Manually calculating and separating tax money from every invoice is tedious. • Apps with fixed monthly budgets make her feel like a failure when she can't meet them in a slow month.
Motivations:	• Primary: Predictability, • Automation (for taxes & savings), • Flexibility. Quote: "I never know exactly what I'll earn next month. I need a tool that adapts to my reality, not one that forces me into a box."

User Journey Map: Freelancer Faith

Scenario: Faith just finished a stressful tax filing season and almost incurred penalties because she hadn't set enough aside. She is determined to do better this year.

Stage	Actions	Thoughts & Feelings	Pain Points	SmartSave Opportunities & Solutions
Awareness	Searches Google for "apps to save for taxes freelance Nigeria."	"I need something specific to my problem, not another general budget app." (Feeling: Determined, Stressed)	General apps do not understand the freelance struggle with taxes and irregular cash flow.	Targeted Content: Create SEO-focused blog posts and ads that speak directly to "saving for taxes as a freelancer" and "managing variable income."
Onboarding	During sign-up, she selects "Freelancer" as her profile. The app immediately suggests creating a "Tax Savings" goal.	"It already knows! I don't have to explain my life." (Feeling: Understood, Relieved)	Hates having to fit her complex situation into a standard setup flow.	Personalized Setup: Use a user type selection (Freelancer, Professional, Business Owner) to tailor the initial setup and goal suggestions.
Setup & Value	Links her business account. Sets up an auto-save rule: "Save 15% of every incoming payment over ₦50k."	"Set it once and never worry about it again? This is a game-changer for my tax stress." (Feeling: In control, Relieved)	The mental burden of manually calculating and transferring tax money from every single payment.	Income-Triggered Automation: Implement %-based savings rules that activate on income deposit, not a fixed date. This is core for freelancers.
Regular Use	After a large invoice payment, she gets a notification: "₦45,000 has been moved to your Tax Savings goal based on your rule."	"It just works. I can finally focus on my work and not my spreadsheet."	Needs confirmation that the automation is working correctly	Confirmation & Reassurance: Send immediate, clear confirmations when automated rules are executed successfully.

		(Feeling: Secure, Professional)	without having to check manually.	
Loyalty	Effortlessly exports a quarterly CSV/Excel report of her business income and saved tax amount for her accountant.	"This just saved me a full day of messy paperwork. Worth every penny." (Feeling: Grateful, Loyal)	Dreads the administrative overhead and time cost of financial reporting.	Value-Added Tooling: Promote easy export features as a key benefit for freelancers and the self-employed, saving them time and hassle.

3. Persona: " Ben" (The Entrepreneur)

Photo:	(Image of a man in his late 30s in a casual shirt, looking focused while reviewing analytics on a tablet in a small office)
Demographics:	Age: 38 Occupation: Owner of a small digital marketing agency Location: Port Harcourt, Nigeria Income: Takes an irregular "draw" from business profits; cash flow is tied to business performance.
Bio:	Ben is a visionary but not a detail person. His business and personal finances are a tangled mess. He often dips into business funds for personal emergencies and vice versa, creating guilt, confusion, and a bookkeeping nightmare. He knows this is holding his business back.
Goals:	- Clearly separate business and personal finances. - Build a 3-month business emergency fund to cover operational costs. - Pay himself a consistent "salary" monthly to simplify his personal budgeting.
Frustrations:	- The guilt and stress of "robbing Peter to pay Paul" between his business and personal accounts. - Lack of discipline to pay himself consistently, leading to personal financial stress that distracts him from business. - No clear view of whether his business is actually building savings for future growth.
Motivations:	Primary: - Separation, - Discipline - Clarity

	Business Growth. Quote: "I need to stop playing banker and start being the CEO. I need a system that enforces the discipline I know I need."
--	--

User Journey Map: Ben the Entrepreneur

Scenario: Ben's bookkeeper emails him, yet again, asking him to categorize a pile of personal expenses paid from the business account. He's frustrated and embarrassed.

Stage	Actions	Thoughts & Feelings	Pain Points	SmartSave Opportunities & Solutions
Awareness	Searches for apps to separate business and personal expenses. Sees Smart-Save listed.	"There has to be a simpler way than me trying to be an accountant." (Feeling: Frustrated, Hopeful)	Feels embarrassed about his messy finances; needs a simple solution, not a complex accounting suite.	Problem-Specific Messaging: Use ad copy that speaks to the pain of mixed expenses and positions SmartSave as a simple "first step" to clarity.
Onboarding	He downloads the app. It immediately suggests creating a "Business Savings" goal.	"Okay, it's putting the business first. Good." (Feeling: Understood)	Worried the app will be too focused on personal finance and not understand his business context.	Business-Centric Framing: For users who indicate they are business owners, use language focused on "business savings," "operational costs," and "tax readiness."
Setup & Value	He links his business current account (not his personal account). He creates a goal for "New Laptop Fund."	"Finally, this savings goal is just for the business. It's not mixed up with my vacation fund." (Feeling: Organized, Relieved)	Not being able to easily see how much is saved for one specific goal, like marketing or new inventory, without manual calculation.	Goal Segregation: The ability to create and label specific, separate goals provides immediate mental clarity and organization for entrepreneurs.
Regular Use	He manually logs an "Owner's Salary" transfer from his business to his personal account. The app tracks it.	"Now I can see that I paid myself this month. It makes me feel more legitimate and in control."	The lack of a system to enforce paying himself a consistent salary.	Manual Tracking as a Feature: A simple way for users to add their own transactions (like owner salary) to get a true and complete view of their finances.

		(Feeling: Professional, Disciplined)		
Loyalty	Before a client meeting, he quickly checks the app to see the status of his business emergency fund.	"I can see our safety net growing right here. That gives me confidence going into this negotiation." (Feeling: Confident, Prepared)	Lack of a quick, simple snapshot of business financial health without digging through bank statements.	At-a-Glance Business Health: Provide a clear, simple dashboard for business goals, giving entrepreneurs a quick sense of their company's financial progress.

4. Persona: "Nurse Tope" (The Trust-Seeker)

Photo:	(Image of a woman in her mid-40s in medical scrubs, looking patient and kind, perhaps on a break at the hospital)
Demographics:	Age: 45 Occupation: Registered Nurse Location: Ibadan, Nigeria Income: Stable, but stretched thin supporting an extended family.
Bio:	Tope is highly intelligent and capable in her job, but technology outside of WhatsApp and Facebook makes her anxious. She prefers human interaction and clear, simple instructions. She uses a savings "ajo" with her colleagues but wants something more private and flexible. She's heard about mobile banking scams and is very cautious about where she puts her financial information.
Goals:	● Save gradually for her children's school fees without a fixed "ajo" date. ● Keep a simple track of where her money goes each month. ● Feel secure that her money and data are safe.
Frustrations:	● Apps are confusing with too many buttons and jargon she doesn't understand. ● She fears making an irreversible mistake (e.g., sending money to the wrong person).

	• She doesn't trust automated systems; she wants to feel in control and understand every step.
Motivations:	Primary: • Security • Simplicity • Trust • Control. Quote: "I just want something simple and safe. I don't need all these complicated graphs. Can I trust this app with my hard-earned money?"

User Journey Map: Nurse Nneka

Scenario: Tope friend at work, whom she trusts, shows her how she's been saving small amounts with SmartSave. She is curious but nervous to try it herself.

Stage	Actions	Thoughts & Feelings	Pain Points	SmartSave Opportunities & Solutions
Awareness	Her trusted friend shows her the app on her phone, demonstrating how she saved for a new generator.	"If Grace says it's safe and simple, maybe it is. She's not a tech person either." (Feeling: Cautiously curious, influenced by trust)	Doesn't trust online ads or influencers. Relies heavily on personal recommendations from people like her.	Referral Programs: Create a simple referral system where trusted friends can guide new users. Word-of-mouth is her most trusted channel.
Onboarding	She downloads the app. The first screen is simple: "Save	"Okay, it looks clean. Not too many	Overwhelmed by technical terms and	Ultra-Simple UI: Use large buttons, clear and simple language, and a minimalistic

	for your goals securely." She clicks a big "Get Started" button.	confusing words. Let's see..." (Feeling: Anxious, taking a risk)	complex options immediately. Fear of the unknown.	design. Avoid financial jargon entirely. Offer a "guided tour" pop-up.
Setup & Value	She walks through one step at a time: 1. Enter phone number. 2. Set a goal: "School Fees." 3. It asks to connect to her bank. She hesitates.	"Connect to my bank? Is that safe? What will it do? I need to understand this before I click." (Feeling: Nervous, skeptical)	Deep fear of linking her bank account. Doesn't understand how APIs work; worries the app will "take" her money.	Security Reassurance: Explain every step. Use text like: "We connect with your bank using their secure login. We can only see your transactions; we can never move money without your permission." Use logos of trusted banking partners.
Regular Use	She decides to start by manually adding a cash expense for "market money." The app saves it easily. She tries the "round-up" feature on a small card transaction.	"Oh, I can just type it in. That's easy. And it saved my extra change? That wasn't scary at all." (Feeling: Relieved, in control, empowered)	Intimidated by full automation. Needs to start with low-risk, high-control options to build confidence.	Manual First, Automated Later: Promote manual tracking and confirm-every-transfer rules as key features for this user group. Allow them to build confidence gradually.
Loyalty	After two weeks, she sees her "School Fees" goal has grown from round-ups without any effort. She feels confident enough to set up a small weekly auto-save.	"It's working! And I didn't even miss the money. Maybe I can let it do a little more for me." (Feeling: Proud, confident, trusting)	Needs to see consistent, predictable, and safe results over time before fully trusting the automation.	Build Trust Gradually: Use the app experience itself, proving its security and value through simple, reliable operation as the primary tool to build loyalty with this segment.